

A N E V I D E N T I A R Y R E P O R T

Systematic Exclusion

Indigenous Disability in Alberta

*Everything I am doing is so people do not feel
alone or unseen or unheard.*

*It gives them the grounds to push back —
from sourced research —
to turn a quiet murmur into a booming proclamation
no one can ignore.*

You are not alone. We stand together.

Compiled by The Alberta Disability System Breakdown
St. Albert, Alberta
April 2026

Preface

A note from the compiler

I am an AISH recipient. I am not Indigenous. I am a single mother of three children in St. Albert, Alberta, and I live within the same provincial disability support system that is the subject of this document.

Since April 2026, I have been building a sourced evidentiary record on the mandatory transition from the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program to the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP), which takes effect July 1, 2026. That work now spans more than fifty reports, formal submissions to the Premier of Alberta, federal ministers, and the United Nations Special Rapporteur on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, and a growing community of Albertans who have joined together to document what is happening to disabled people in this province.

This report is different.

What is happening to disabled Albertans under Bill 12 is not happening to every community equally. For Indigenous Albertans with disabilities, the harm is layered on top of decades of jurisdictional failure, broken treaty obligations, documented systemic racism in the healthcare system, and the ongoing consequences of colonial policy. The current advocacy landscape — including much of my own work to date — has not adequately addressed those layers.

This document is an attempt to correct that gap in the record.

What this document is

This is a sourced evidentiary report. Every claim it makes about Indigenous experience in Alberta is cited to Indigenous organizations, Indigenous-led research, Treaty bodies, federal court rulings, Statistics Canada data, Alberta Health Ministry reporting, and peer-reviewed publications. Where primary Indigenous voices exist on these issues — and they do, extensively — they are cited, not paraphrased. Where they do not yet exist on a given question, that absence is named as part of the evidence.

This document is not written to speak for Indigenous Albertans. It is written to make sure that the evidentiary record on the ADAP transition, and on the provincial disability support system more broadly, does not continue forward as if Indigenous disabled people do not exist within it.

What this document is not

It is not a replacement for Indigenous-led advocacy. It is not a comprehensive account of Indigenous disability experience in Alberta — that account can only be written by Indigenous Albertans themselves, and several organizations are doing that work. It is not an attempt to claim authority over narratives that are not mine.

It is a compilation. It is a witness. It is a contribution to a public record that has been built selectively and that currently treats the most structurally disadvantaged disabled Albertans as if they were a footnote to a conversation about the middle of the population.

They are not a footnote. The evidence in the pages that follow establishes that the sharpest edge of every harm documented in the broader campaign — mortality, incarceration, housing, healthcare access, jurisdictional abandonment — falls hardest on Indigenous Albertans. Any honest account of the ADAP transition has to begin from that reality.

Why this document exists

Because a quiet murmur is what happens when people are left to carry the weight alone. A booming proclamation is what happens when the evidence is assembled, the sources are named, and the record is made unignorable.

This document is assembled so that Indigenous Albertans with disabilities who encounter it — and the advocates, legal workers, policy staff, journalists, and community members who work alongside them — have one more piece of the record they can point to. Not as permission to speak. They already have that. As reinforcement, where reinforcement is useful. As citation, where citation makes the pushback hold.

The sources in this report are public. They were always public. What this document does is gather them in one place, with a consistent analytical frame, so that the pattern they form together is visible on a single reading.

You are not alone.

What is happening is seen.

We stand together.

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Sources and citations are embedded throughout. Every numerical claim is attributed to a primary source. Public domain data, public government documents, and peer-reviewed research form the evidentiary base.